

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

Key findings for engineering managers and HR leaders benchmarking developer compensation, hiring strategy, and workplace expectations.

65,437

SURVEY RESPONDENTS

180+

COUNTRIES REPRESENTED

Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Developer Survey, Work section.

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global respondent mix

84%

CURRENTLY WORKING

69%

FULL-TIME

16.4%

FREELANCE / CONTRACT



■ FULL-TIME ■ FREELANCE ■ STUDENT

Full-time employment remains the dominant mode, followed by independent contracting/freelancing and full-time students.

64.8%

U.S. FULL-TIME IN 2024

U.S. full-time employment dropped from 69% in 2023 to 64.8% in 2024 — a roughly four-point decline.

Non-full-time patterns vary by market: the U.K. and Ukraine lean toward contracting, while Germany and India skew toward students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Three-year arrangement trend

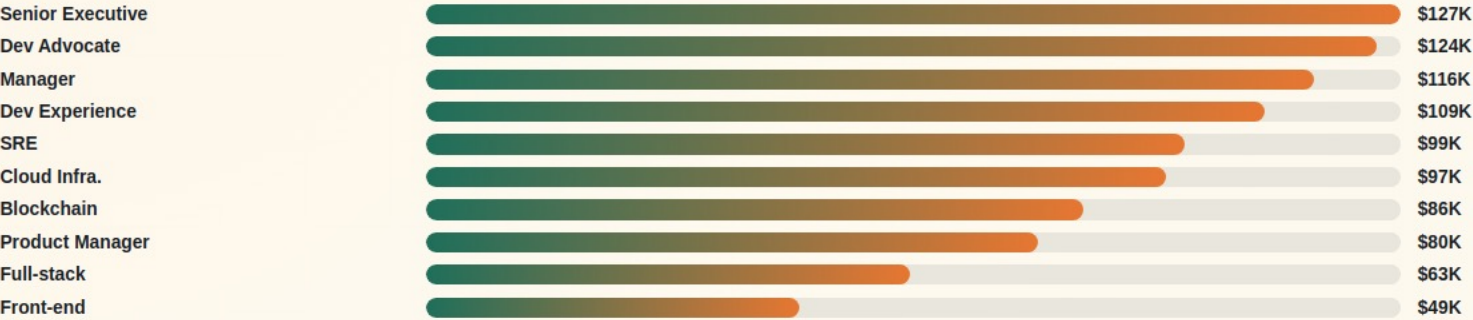


Benchmarking implication

- **Hybrid is still the center of gravity:** 42% in 2024, consistent with 2023.
- **Remote remains material:** 38% of respondents report remote work.
- **Return-to-office is gradual:** in-person increased from 15% to 16% to 20% over three years.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Top 10 roles by median compensation (USD)



22,677 SALARY RESPONSES

Leadership and developer relations roles command the premium end of the market.

Among purely technical roles, SRE and cloud infrastructure engineers are highest-paid in the provided benchmark set.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Pattern to benchmark

- Senior Executive, Dev Advocate, and Manager roles pair 15+ years with top median compensation.
- Dev Experience sits above \$109K with roughly 12 years of experience.
- Student is the visible low-salary outlier at \$15K and roughly 2 years.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

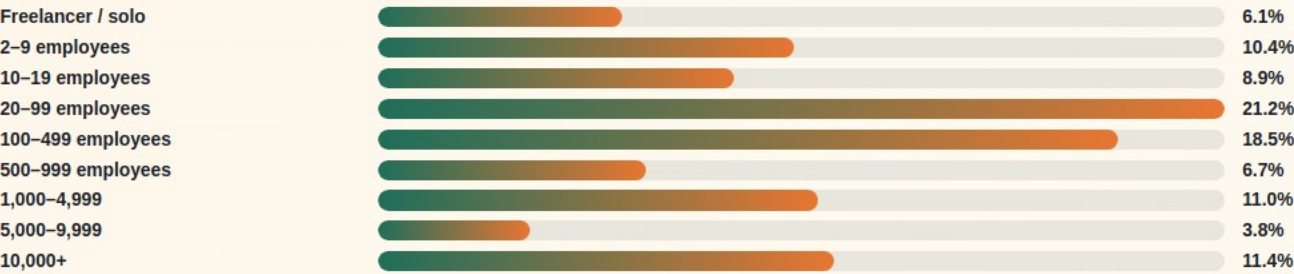


Language premium signal

- Niche functional languages lead: Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), Elixir (~\$93K).
- Mainstream JavaScript (~\$64K) and PHP (~\$49K) sit below the top cluster.
- The overall reported salary range dropped roughly \$10K versus 2023.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size distribution (42,827 respondents)



62%

INFLUENCE TECH PURCHASES

60%

PREFER BUILD-AND-BUY

Senior executives (99%), engineering managers (87%), and product managers (77%) wield the most influence.

Evaluation starts with free trials (75%) and asking other developers (73%).

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Plan for more flexible talent

Full-time employment is softening in the U.S.; contracting and freelancing remain significant at 16%+ globally.

Keep hybrid competitive

In-person work is rising, but hybrid remains the largest arrangement at 42%.

Price premium technical operations

SRE and cloud infrastructure roles lead purely technical pay in the benchmark set.

Account for language premiums

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir exceed \$93K median, while JavaScript and PHP sit below \$65K.

Engage developer buyers

With 62% influencing purchases, vendor and tooling decisions should reach individual contributors directly.